SCHEME

Question Paper Code : **25901064**

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

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Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG1MDCTHM100 - TOURISM PRODUCT& DEVELOPMENT

Part A

short answer. Answer all questions

Each question carries 2 marks

1. Identify a government festival promoting Indian arts.

Nishagandhi Festival Classical Dance and Music (Mohiniyattam, Bharatanatyam, Kathak, etc.)

Khajuraho Dance Festival Classical Indian Dance (Promotes various regional classical dance forms in a historical setting)

Surajkund International Crafts Mela Handlooms, Handicrafts, Folk Arts (Promotes traditional crafts and folk performances from different states and international participants)

2.Name the five A's of tourism.

Attraction – Accessibilities – Accommodation – Amenities – Activities

3. List two UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India.

- **Taj Mahal** (Agra, Uttar Pradesh)
- **Ajanta Caves** (Maharashtra)

4. Identify a hill station as a nature-based attraction

- **Munnar** (Kerala)
- **Darjeeling** (West Bengal)
- **Manali** (Himachal Pradesh)

5. Mention one Ayurveda treatment for relaxation.

Shirodhara, Pizhichil (Oil Bath), Head Massage, Body Massage, Foot Massage

Part B

short essay. Answer any 5

questions Each question carries 5 marks

6. Explain the impact of festivals on pilgrimage tourism.

- **Increased VisitationFestivals** create fixed dates for mass gatherings, generating huge, predictable surges in pilgrim arrivals.
- **Economic Boost** They drive massive revenue for local economies through spending on accommodation, transport, food, and religious offerings.
- **Infrastructure Development** Festivals necessitate and spur the building or upgrading of essential amenities (roads, sanitation, temporary housing, crowd management).
- **Social Cohesion** They enhance the feeling of community and shared faith among pilgrims, strengthening the spiritual and social bond of the site.
- **Cultural Promotion** Festivals integrate local arts, music, and rituals into the pilgrimage, promoting the unique cultural heritage of the destination to a wider audience.

7. Analyze economic benefits of diverse tourism products in India.

Diversified Foreign Exchange Earnings: By offering products like Medical Tourism, Heritage Tourism, and Adventure Tourism, India can attract high-spending international visitors throughout the year, ensuring a **steady and varied inflow of foreign currency**.

Wider Employment Generation: Diverse products create specialized jobs across various sectors (e.g., Doctors for Medical Tourism, Guides for Heritage sites, trainers for Adventure sports), increasing **overall employment volume and skill diversity** in both urban and rural areas.

Reduced Regional Disparities: The focus on niche products (like Eco-Tourism and Wellness) drives investment and tourist traffic to previously **underserved regions and rural areas** (e.g., homestays in the Northeast or Ayurveda centers in Kerala), ensuring more equitable economic growth across the country.

Enhanced Multiplier Effect: Diversification stimulates growth in related industries (forward and backward linkages). For instance, Wellness Tourism boosts demand for local organic products and Ayurvedic equipment, multiplying the initial tourist spending across multiple **local supply chains and MSMEs**.

Year-Round Revenue Stability: Relying on a mix of products (e.g., beaches in winter, mountains in summer, and medical/heritage year-round) reduces the impact of seasonality, providing the sector with a more **stable and predictable revenue stream** regardless of weather or regional fluctuations.

8. Analyse the impact of performing arts on cultural identity and tourism.

- **Reinforces Cultural Identity:** Performing arts act as a living archive, passing down indigenous stories, customs, and philosophies across generations. This continuous tradition strengthens the sense of identity and authenticity for the local community.

- **Creates Unique Tourist Attractions:** Performances (such as Kathakali in Kerala or the Ghoomar in Rajasthan) transform a simple location into a dynamic cultural product. They offer tourists a unique, *experiential* reason to visit that cannot be found elsewhere.

- **Preserves Intangible Heritage:** Tourism demand for authentic performances provides an economic incentive to maintain traditional art forms, saving them from obsolescence and providing livelihoods for artists who are keepers of the culture.

- **Enhances Destination Branding:** A distinct performing art form (e.g., Bhangra for Punjab or Mohiniyattam for Kerala) becomes a powerful visual symbol and marketing tool, giving the destination a recognizable and memorable cultural brand identity on the global stage.

- **Encourages Deep Cultural Exchange:** Watching a traditional performance moves tourists beyond simple sightseeing. It fosters emotional connection, increases cultural understanding, and encourages visitors to seek out further interaction, transforming them from passive consumers into appreciative guests.

9. Compare North and South Indian culinary traditions in tourism context.

North Indian cuisine attracts tourists with its rich, creamy, and wheat-based dishes (like naan, butter chicken, and tandoori), reflecting Mughal influence and suiting colder climates.

Conversely, South Indian cuisine appeals to travelers seeking lighter, tangier, and often healthier options that are predominantly rice-based, featuring coconut, curry leaves, and fermentation (like idli, dosa, and sambar).

10. Illustrate various types of tourism products using real Indian examples.

Heritage & Cultural Tourism Products based on historical sites, ancient architecture, cultural practices, and local traditions.**Taj Mahal** (Uttar Pradesh); **Hampi** (Karnataka); **Ajanta & Ellora Caves** (Maharashtra).

Nature & Wildlife Tourism Products focused on natural beauty, biodiversity, national parks, and ecological experiences.**Kerala Backwaters** (Kerala); **Kaziranga National Park** (Assam) for the One-Horned Rhino; **Jim Corbett National Park** (Uttarakhand).

Adventure Tourism Products offering high-adrenaline, participatory experiences that involve physical exertion and risk.**Trekking and Mountaineering** in Ladakh/Sikkim; **River Rafting** on the Ganges (Rishikesh); **Skiing** in Gulmarg (Jammu & Kashmir).

Wellness & Medical Tourism Products combining healthcare services with hospitality, including traditional and modern medical treatments.**Ayurveda Resorts** in Kerala; **High-end hospitals** in Chennai/Delhi for cost-effective surgical procedures.

Luxury & Rail Tourism Products that focus on high-end, all-inclusive travel experiences with bespoke services and luxury accommodation.**Palace on Wheels** (Luxury train touring Rajasthan's royal sites); **Maharajas' Express** (Luxury cross-country rail journey).

11. Illustrate the influence of regional culture on Indian folk music.

nal culture on Indian folk music is shown through its **themes and narratives** (reflecting local life), **rhythm** (tied to occupational and festive cycles), and **unique regional instrumentation**. This deep connection ensures the music is a powerful and authentic carrier of **local language, oral history, and specific cultural traditions**.

12. Describe the role of the Ministry of Tourism in promoting sustainableand responsible tourism in India.

the Ministry of Tourism (MoT) primarily promotes sustainable and responsible tourism by **formulating national policies and guidelines** that ensure environmental preservation, socio-cultural authenticity, and economic benefits for local communities. The MoT also **provides financial assistance** for developing eco-friendly infrastructure and certifying sustainable practices across the tourism sector.

Part C

long essay . Answer any 1 questions

Each question carries 15 marks

13. Analyze the importance of inter-governmental coordination (Central,State, and local bodies) in the growth and management of Indian tourism.

- **Unified Policy and Standards:** Central bodies set national standards and marketing strategies (e.g., Incredible India), which require State and local bodies to implement them uniformly, ensuring a **consistent, high-quality tourist experience** across all regions.

- **Infrastructure Synergy:** Major projects like national highways, airport development (Central), and last-mile connectivity/local roads (State/Local) require joint planning and funding to ensure **tourists can access destinations efficiently** from national entry points.

- **Safety and Security:** Effective security and disaster management protocols must be coordinated between Central agencies (intelligence), State police, and local law enforcement, guaranteeing **tourist safety and confidence** in the destination.

- **Resource Mobilization:** Sharing of financial resources (Central grants like PRASAD or SWADESH) and technical expertise between the three tiers allows for the **optimal utilization of funds** to develop major projects that no single body could undertake alone.

- **Regulation and Licensing:** Clear demarcation of licensing authority and environmental oversight among the three tiers prevents bureaucratic hurdles and conflicts, enabling **faster approval for private investments** while maintaining sustainable practices.

14. Discuss the role of pilgrimage tourism in India's tourism industry, highlighting major destinations of different religions.

Massive Economic Contribution: Pilgrimage sites generate vast and consistent revenue through donations, local services (food, flowers, souvenirs), and transportation, creating millions of jobs and contributing significantly to the national **GDP.**

Essential Infrastructure Driver: The constant influx of large crowds necessitates major government investment in **infrastructure projects** (roads, rail links, airports, sanitation) under schemes like PRASAD, directly benefiting both pilgrims and the local population.

National and Social Integration: Pilgrimage fosters a sense of unity by drawing domestic and international visitors from all socio-economic backgrounds and regions to shared sacred spaces, promoting **national cohesion** and inter-cultural understanding.

Preservation of Heritage: The financial viability driven by pilgrims ensures the maintenance, protection, and restoration of ancient temples, mosques, churches, and stupas, safeguarding India's **diverse architectural and religious heritage**.

Major Multi-Religious Destinations: India's strength lies in its diverse destinations:

- **Hindu:** Varanasi (Kashi Vishwanath), Tirupati (Andhra Pradesh), Char Dham (Badrinath, Puri, Rameshwaram, Dwarka).
- **Sikh:** Golden Temple (Harmandir Sahib), Amritsar.
- **Islamic:** Ajmer Sharif Dargah (Rajasthan), Haji Ali Dargah (Mumbai).
- **Buddhist:** Bodh Gaya (Bihar), Sarnath (Uttar Pradesh).
- **Christian:** Basilica of Our Lady of Good Health (Velankanni, Tamil Nadu), St. Thomas Syro-Malabar Church (Malayattoor, Kerala).